

Advanced Chama Management System

Glossary of Terms

Generated: 01 July 2026 13:55

Version 1.0

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Glossary of Terms

Advanced Chama Management System â€” Plain English definitions.

Account â€” A category in the chart of accounts used for double-entry bookkeeping (e.g., "Cash at Bank", "Loan Receivables").

Activity Log â€” A record of user actions (logins, page visits) used for monitoring.

Agenda â€” A list of topics or items to be discussed during a meeting.

Amortization â€” The process of paying off a loan through regular installments over time.

Announcement â€” A broadcast message visible to all users or a specific group role.

Attendance â€” A record of which members were present at a meeting.

Audit Log â€” A detailed record of every change made to data, including who made it, what was changed, and when.

Authentication â€” The process of verifying a user's identity (logging in).

Authorization â€” The process of determining what a user is allowed to do (permissions).

Balance â€” The remaining amount owed on a loan, or the current value of an account.

Beneficiary â€” A person designated to receive benefits, such as upon a member's death (not fully implemented).

Breadcrumb â€” A navigation trail showing the current page location (not implemented in this system).

Certificate â€” A unique number assigned to each share purchase for identification.

Chama â€” An informal savings and investment group, common in Kenya and East Africa.

Chart of Accounts â€” The complete list of financial accounts used in the group's bookkeeping system.

Collateral â€” An asset (e.g., land title, vehicle logbook) pledged as security for a loan.

Contribution â€” Money paid by a member into the group's savings pool.

Contribution Type â€” A category of contribution with its own amount and frequency (e.g., Monthly Savings, Welfare Fund).

Credit â€” In double-entry accounting, an entry on the right side that decreases assets or increases liabilities.

CSRF (Cross-Site Request Forgery) â€” A security attack where a malicious website tricks a user into submitting a request. The system uses CSRF tokens to prevent this.

CSRF Token â€” A unique, hidden value in each form that verifies the form submission came from the legitimate site.

Dashboard â€” The main overview page displayed after login, showing key statistics and recent activity.

Debit â€” In double-entry accounting, an entry on the left side that increases assets or decreases liabilities.

- Disbursement** â€” The release of approved loan funds to a borrower.
- Dividend** â€” A share of profits distributed to members who own shares (not fully implemented).
- Double-Entry** â€” An accounting method where every transaction affects at least two accounts, with total debits equalling total credits.
- Expense** â€” Money spent by the group on operations (e.g., transport, stationery, rent).
- Favicon** â€” A small icon displayed in the browser tab.
- Flash Message** â€” A temporary notification that appears at the top of a page after an action (e.g., "Member saved successfully").
- Group Code** â€” A unique identifier shared by all users and members of the same chama group.
- Guarantor** â€” A member who agrees to repay a loan if the primary borrower defaults.
- Income** â€” Money received by the group (e.g., loan interest, registration fees).
- Journal Entry** â€” A double-entry accounting record that debits one or more accounts and credits others.
- Ledger** â€” A page or view showing all transactions for a specific account.
- Loan Product** â€” A predefined loan type with specific terms: interest rate, amount limits, tenure, fees.
- Member** â€” An individual who belongs to the chama group.
- Member Number** â€” A unique identifier automatically assigned to each member (e.g., CHM-2024-0001).
- Minutes** â€” The official written record of what was discussed, decided, and actioned in a meeting.
- Notification** â€” An in-app alert informing a user about an event (e.g., loan approved, new announcement).
- Pagination** â€” Splitting a long list of records across multiple numbered pages.
- PDO (PHP Data Objects)** â€” A database access layer used by the system for secure SQL queries.
- Permission** â€” A specific action a user is allowed to perform (e.g., `create\_members`, `approve\_loans`).
- Prepared Statement** â€” A secure way to execute SQL queries by separating the query structure from the data.
- Receipt Number** â€” A unique identifier automatically generated for each contribution or payment transaction.
- Role** â€” A job function (e.g., Treasurer, Secretary) that determines which permissions a user has.
- Role Slug** â€” A short, machine-readable version of the role name (e.g., `loan\_officer`, `super\_admin`).
- Schedule** â€” A loan repayment plan showing each installment's due date, amounts, and remaining balance.
- Session** â€” A period of active login, during which the user's state is maintained on the server.
- Share** â€” A unit of ownership in the group's investment pool, purchased by members.
- SMTP (Simple Mail Transfer Protocol)** â€” The standard protocol for sending emails. Settings exist but are not functional.
- Soft Delete** â€” Marking a record as inactive instead of permanently deleting it from the database.
- Tenure** â€” The duration of a loan, typically expressed in months.

Trial Balance – An accounting report listing all accounts with their total debits and credits to verify they balance.

Upsert – A database operation that inserts a new record or updates an existing one if it already exists (INSERT ... ON DUPLICATE KEY UPDATE).